



COACH FIELD GUIDE

RECREATIONAL GYMNASTICS

Skills, coaching cues & progressions for Levels 1–6.
Built for quick reference on tablet or phone, pitch-side.

SAFETY & KEY TERMS

Read before every session

SAFETY RULES

1. Always warm up before training — cold muscles injure more easily.
2. Only attempt skills with the coach present, even repeated ones.
3. Follow instructions immediately — they're for safety.
4. No jewellery, watches or hard accessories.
5. Hair tied back securely at all times.
6. Appropriate gymnastics clothing — bare feet or gym shoes only.
7. Report pain or injury immediately, never work through it.
8. No distracting other gymnasts — stay focused.
9. Respect the apparatus — never hang, sit or play unless instructed.
10. Spotting mats in position before any skill is attempted.

KEY TERMS

(S)	Supported — coach provides physical assistance
(US)	Unsupported — performed independently
B&P	Block and Present — stop, hold 3 secs, present
(LB)	Low Bar
(HB)	High Bar
(PYT)	Point Your Toes
Vault height 2/3/4	Height setting of the vault box
Balances	Held for a minimum of 3 seconds
Present	Stand tall, arms raised, show confidence
Dish	Hollow body — lower back pressed down, arms/legs raised
Arch	Opposite of dish — gentle back curve
Japana	Straddle position with forward lean, reaching to feet

FOUNDATION

BEAM

- **Straddle mount (supported)**

Hands on beam, legs apart, coach lifts hips into straddle sit.

- **Tiptoes (supported)**

Rise tall onto toes, arms out for balance, coach spots hips.

- **Diddy Walk**

Small steps, pointed toes, eyes forward not down.

- **Leg Lifts (supported)**

Hold beam, lift leg slow and controlled, hips stay square.

- **Straight Jump Dismount**

Push through legs, stretch tall in the air, land soft and stick.

- **Block (hold 3 secs)**

Land square, arms up, freeze and hold before moving.

- **Present**

Stand tall, chest up, big smile, arms out to finish.

BARS

- **Hold Tuck, Straddle & Pike (LB or HB)**

Knees to chest / legs wide / legs straight up — hold each shape still.

- **LB — Hang upside down, up-circle (S)**

Relax the shoulders in the hang, coach guides hips over the bar.

- **LB — Forward circle (S)**

Tight tummy, coach supports the rotation around the bar.

- **HB — Dish/Arch 5 swings**

Squeeze into dish going forward, open into arch coming back.

- **Dismount, Block and Present**

Push away from the bar, land soft, freeze, then present.

FLOOR

- **Dish & Arch hold 3 seconds**

Belly button to spine for dish, gentle curve for arch.

- **Front & Back Support 3 secs**

Straight body line, shoulders over wrists, don't let the hips sag.

- **Arabesque angle**

Stand tall, one leg lifts back, chest and leg rise together.

- **Forward roll (S)**

Chin to chest, push through the shoulders, roll in a straight line.

- **Bunny Hop forward and side**

Hands down first, feet follow together, land soft.

- **V-Sit (S)**

Sit tall, lift legs and chest together to make a V.

- **Chasse**

Step, close feet together in the air, land lightly.

- **Side Splits**

Slide legs apart slowly, hips square, hold — don't bounce.

- **Front Splits**

Front leg forward, back leg straight behind, hips facing forward.

- **Straight Jump B&P**

Reach up tall, land soft, freeze and present.

REBOUND

- **Run into Hurdle Step**

Quick building steps, one big last step onto two feet.

- **Jump to Springboard**

Land both feet together in the centre of the board.

- **Safe Landing B&P**

Bend the knees to absorb, land square, freeze and hold.

- **Standing Squat to feet (vault height 2)**

Hands push off the box, knees to chest, feet land together.

- **Straight jump off B&P**

Stretch tall in the air, land soft, freeze and present.

- **Standing Straddle to feet (2)**

Legs wide over the box, hands push, feet together to land.

- **Star jump off B&P**

Arms and legs open wide in the air, land soft and still.

DEVELOPING

BEAM

- **Straddle lever swing or V-Sit mount (S)**

Controlled swing of the legs into straddle sit, coach supports hips.

- **Dips**

Small knee bend and rise, stay tall through the spine.

- **½ Pivot turn (S)**

Rise onto toes, spot a point, turn smooth and controlled.

- **Leg Lifts (S)**

Slow controlled lift, hips square, toes pointed.

- **Arabesque**

Unsupported now — lift and hold, chest and leg rise together.

- **Star Jump dismount**

Arms and legs open wide, land soft, feet together.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present**

Land, freeze for three, then present with arms up.

BARS

- **HB — Tuck, Straddle & Pike Hold (5 secs)**

Hold each shape longer now, control the wobble.

- **LB — Jump to Front Support (bar to knee) x3**

Jump up, arms straight, hips on the bar, repeat smoothly.

- **HB — Dish/Arch 10 swings and static turns x2**

Bigger swings now, add a controlled turn at the top.

- **Re-grasping (S optional)**

Release and re-catch the bar smoothly, coach ready to support.

- **Back release Dismount B&P**

Swing back, release with control, land soft and present.

FLOOR

- **Dish & Arch rocks and rolls**

Rock gently between the shapes, keep the position tight.

- **Side, Front & Back Support**

Hold each position with a straight, strong line.

- **Splits — Side and Front**

Both directions now, hold with square hips.

- **T Balance**

Stand on one leg, lean forward as the other lifts to make a T.

- **Frog Balance**

Hands down, knees on elbows, lift the feet, hold the balance.

- **Forward Roll**

Smooth roll to stand, no hands needed to push up.

- **Back Roll to straddle stand (S)**

Push through the hands over the head, legs open to stand.

- **Handstand (S)**

Hands shoulder width, kick up straight, coach supports the legs.

- **V-Sit (unsupported)**

Hold independently now, chest and legs lifted together.

- **Bridge (S)**

Push the hips up, straight arms, coach supports the lower back.

- **Chassé Catleaps**

Step, leap changing legs in the air, land softly.

- **Tuck Jump B&P**

Knees to chest in the air, land soft, freeze.

REBOUND

- **Run into Hurdle Step on Springboard**

Build speed, one strong last step onto the board.

- **Squat to feet on low vault (2/3)**

Hands push, knees bend to clear, feet land together.

- **Tuck jump off, Block & Present**

Knees to chest off the vault, land, freeze, present.

- **Straddle to feet on low vault (2/3)**

Legs wide over the vault, hands push, feet together to land.

- **Star jump off, Block and Present**

Arms and legs wide in flight, land soft, present.

PROGRESSING

BEAM

- **V-Sit / kneeling leg lift / simple individual mount**

No support now — controlled entry onto the beam.

- **Dipped Leg Lifts**

Small dip before the lift, control the wobble.

- **½ Pivot turn on toe**

Rise fully onto toes, spot and turn with control.

- **Straight Jump (S)**

Push tall, stretch in the air, soft landing.

- **Y Balance (S)**

Leg lifts to the side and up, chest stays tall.

- **Coupe Ankles**

Small controlled foot position, ankle crossed at the other calf.

- **V-Sit to shoulderstand, roll to stand**

Roll back with control, legs together, roll back up to stand.

- **Tuck Jump dismount**

Knees to chest, land soft, control the landing.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present**

Hold the landing, then present with confidence.

BARS

- **LB — Up hip circle (S)**

Hips stay on the bar, coach guides the rotation.

- **LB — Cast x3 to dismount jump to front support**

Push hips away from the bar, straight body, land in support.

- **LB — Forward dismount (straight legs and arms)**

Full extension through the dismount, land with control.

- **HB — 10 Swings with Re-grasping (unsupported)**

Independent swings now, smooth release and catch.

- **2x Half Turns**

Controlled turn at the top of the swing, both directions.

- **Rear Dismount, Block and Finish**

Swing, release, land soft, freeze and present.

FLOOR

- **Dish & Arch rolls and press**

Roll through the shape and press to hold.

- **Side, Front & Back Support with press**

Add a press-up from the support position.

- **Splits**

Deepen the range, hold with control, no bouncing.

- **Y Balance**

Leg lifts to the side, chest stays lifted.

- **Dive Forward Roll**

Small push off the floor into the roll, land in a squat.

- **Back Roll**

Push through the hands, roll with control to stand.

- **Headstand**

Triangle base with hands and head, push hips up slowly.

- **Handstand**

Kick up straight, hold the line, controlled entry.

- **Cartwheel (S)**

Hand, hand, foot, foot — coach supports the hips.

- **Shoulderstand (S)**

Legs straight up, hips supported by the hands.

- **Back Bend into Bridge**

Reach back and over, land with straight arms.

- **Chassé Catleaps, high hops**

Bigger, higher leaps, controlled landings.

- **Straddle Jump B&P**

Legs wide in the air, land soft, freeze and present.

REBOUND

- **Squat on or over (vault 3/4), Tuck jump off**

Hands push, knees clear the vault, tuck off the end.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present**

Land, freeze, then present.

- **Straddle on or over (3/4), Straddle jump off**

Legs wide over the vault, straddle off the far end.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present (2)**

Hold the landing, then present.

ADVANCING

BEAM

- **Individual mount (simple)**

No support — controlled step or jump onto the beam.

- **Dipped Leg Lifts on tiptoes**

Rise to toes first, then add the controlled lift.

- **Squat Pivot Turn**

Bend the knees slightly through the turn for control.

- **Forward Roll**

First roll on the beam — tuck tight, stay central.

- **Coupe Knees $\frac{1}{2}$ pivot 1 foot**

Turn on one foot, other leg tucked at the calf.

- **Y Balance (unsupported)**

Independent hold now, chest and leg lifted together.

- **Tuck Jump (S)**

Knees tight to chest, land with control.

- **Cat Leap**

Push from one leg, knees drive up, switch legs in the air.

- **Handspring (S) OR Cartwheel $\frac{1}{4}$ Turn Dismount**

Strong push through the shoulders, land facing forward.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present**

Hold the landing, then present.

BARS

- **LB — Up hip circle (single leg allowed)**

Hips on the bar, drive the free leg to help rotate.

- **LB — Casts to Back Hip Circle (S)**

Push away then rotate back around the bar with support.

- **LB — Stand on or straddle from cast to LB, jump to HB**

Transition with control, eyes up to the high bar.

- **HB — 10 Swings re-grasping**

Bigger swings, smooth release and catch each time.

- **2x Half Turns**

Controlled turns at the top of the swing.

- **German Back Hang in Pike (S)**

Hang with control in pike, coach supports the position.

- **Dismount, Block and Finish**

Release with control, land soft, present.

FLOOR

- **Dish & Arch rolls and press**

Continue building strength through the press.

- **Side, Front & Back Support with fall**

Control the fall into support, straight strong line.

- **Splits**

Full range, controlled entry and exit.

- **Elbow Balance**

Elbows tucked into the hips, find the balance point slowly.

- **Dive Forward Roll to bunny hop HS**

Roll then push straight into a handstand shape.

- **Back Roll to Front Support**

Roll through and push up into support at the end.

- **Handstand Forward Roll**

Kick to handstand, tuck the chin, roll out smoothly.

- **Cartwheel (1-handed / side to side)**

Reduce the hand support, keep the line straight.

- **Shoulderstand**

Independent hold, straight legs, hips supported by the hands.

- **Backward Walkover**

Reach back and over with a strong leg drive.

- **Chassé, Catleaps, high hops, stag leaps**

Vary the leaps, focus on height and shape.

- **Roundoff**

Hand, hand, snap the legs together, push to land facing back.

REBOUND

- **Head/Hand Spring off box top (S)**

Rotate over the top with coach support, land with control.

- **Squat on, tuck off (vault 4)**

Hands push, knees clear, tuck shape off the end.

- **Squat Through (3/4)**

Legs pass through the hands in squat, land beyond the vault.

- **Straddle on, straddle off (4)**

Legs wide onto then off the vault, controlled landing.

- **Straddle Over (3/4)**

Legs wide clearing the vault in one motion.

- **Block and Present**

Land, freeze, then present.

PERFORMANCE

BEAM

- **Springboard Tuck Jump Mount (S)**

Jump from the board, tuck onto the beam with support.

- **Full Coupe**

Full ankle-cross position, controlled and held.

- **½ and Full Pivot Turn on Toes**

Rise fully onto toes for both turns, spot each time.

- **Kneeling Leg Swings to Lift**

Swing from kneeling into a controlled leg lift.

- **Y Balance**

Independent, full extension, chest lifted.

- **Star Jump (S)**

Arms and legs open wide, coach supports the landing.

- **Jump ½ Turn and Jump Full Turn**

Spot the turn, land square each time.

- **Handstand (S)**

Strong kick, hold the line, coach supports if needed.

- **Cartwheel (S)**

Increasing independence, straight line through the cartwheel.

- **Roundoff Dismount**

Push to land facing the beam, controlled finish.

- **Block (3 secs) and Present**

Hold, then present.

BARS

- **LB — Up hip circle (from 2 feet)**

Start from standing, hips stay connected through rotation.

- **LB — Casts to clear Hip Circle (US)**

Independent circle now, full extension on the cast.

- **LB — Squat/straddle swing to undershoot**

Swing under the bar with control, build the shape.

- **Repeat: squat/straddle on, jump to HB, 2x ½ turns**

Smooth transition, controlled turns at the top.

- **German Back Hang Dismount OR Forward ½ Turn Dismount**

Choose the dismount, commit fully, land with control.

- **Block and Present**

Land, freeze, then present.

FLOOR

- **Back Roll to Handstand**

Roll back and push straight into a handstand line.

- **Handstand Pirouette**

Turn on the hands, keep the line tight.

- **Cartwheel consecutive**

Chain cartwheels smoothly, minimal pause between.

- **Back Handspring (S)**

Sit back, block through the shoulders, coach supports the flight.

- **Forward Walkover (S)**

Reach forward and over, strong leg drive, coach supports.

REBOUND

- **Squat Through B&P**

Legs pass through the hands, land, freeze, present.

- **Straddle Over B&P**

Legs wide clearing in one motion, land and present.

- **Headspring (3/4 vault) B&P**

Rotate off the head with control, land, freeze, present.

- **Handspring (3/4 vault) B&P**

Full extension through the handspring, land, freeze, present.

- **Dive Forward Roll (Trampet)**

Small dive, roll with control on landing.

- **Handstand flat back (Trampet)**

Kick to handstand, control the fall to flat back landing.

EXCELLENCE

BEAM

- **Individual Mount**

Confident independent entry onto the beam.

- **Travelling at least 2 lengths of the beam**

Varied steps and turns, maintain control throughout.

- **4 jumps, leaps and turns**

Combine skills fluently, show height and shape.

- **3 balances**

Hold with control, show a range of shapes.

- **2 travelling moves**

Smooth transitions, confident movement along the beam.

- **1 tumble dismount**

Full commitment, land with control off the beam.

BARS

- **LB — Up hip circle (from 2 feet)**

Confident, controlled circle from standing.

- **LB — Casts to clear Hip Circle**

Full extension, independent rotation.

- **LB — Squat/straddle swing to upstart**

Build momentum into the upstart with control.

- **Repeat: squat/straddle on, jump to HB upstart, 2x ½ turn jumps**

Smooth sequence, controlled turns.

- **Forward swing Back Tuck dismount**

Full commitment through the dismount, land with control.

- **Block and Present**

Land, freeze, then present.

FLOOR

- **Roundoff Back Tuck**

Strong roundoff into the tuck, land with control.

- **Roundoff BHS multiple**

Chain the skills smoothly, maintain rhythm.

- **Flyspring**

Full extension and rotation, land with control.

- **Aerial**

No hand support — full leg drive through the rotation.

REBOUND

- **Squat Through B&P**

Confident execution, land, freeze, present.

- **Straddle Over B&P**

Confident execution, land, freeze, present.

- **Handspring ½ turn B&P**

Full rotation and turn, land, freeze, present.

- **Front Tuck (Trampet)**

Full rotation with control, land, freeze, present.

- **Back Tuck (from platform)**

Full commitment, spot the landing, land, freeze, present.



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